

Playtesting – Misty Rainforest – 12th November 2025

1. Playtesting purpose

The goal of this playtesting was to assess the early-game experience of Misty Rainforest, focusing on how Level 1 introduces the core mechanics. Testers were specifically asked to evaluate:

- Whether the physics and movement felt appropriate and intuitive
- Whether the animations correctly matched the player's input
- Player perceptions of the combat system
- The handling of the playable character
- The overall difficulty of the level

This level serves as a tutorial-style introduction, making its balance and clarity critical to system understanding

2. Method

Students in the classroom played Level 1 using keyboard controls and were observed by the development team. Verbal feedback was collected immediately after each play, focusing on play feel, responsiveness, and clarity. Notes were taken during play to capture player frustration, confusion, or positive engagement moments.

3. Feedback summary

A. Physics & Character handling

- Players felt like the character moved at a comfortable and predictable speed
- Jumping was described as “light but fair”, indicating the physics matched expectations of a skeleton character

- Some testers requested slightly slower movement or less reactive controls for more precision

B. Animation quality & Input response

- Testers reported that attack and movement animations matched most inputs correctly
- A few players observed a delay in the attack animation, making it unclear when damage was dealt
- Idle-to-walk transitions were positively noted

C. Combat system

- Players generally understood how to use the spear attack
- The main critique was that combat lacked visual or audio feedback when striking enemies
- Some players were unclear whether hits were registering due to the limited reaction response from enemies

D. Difficulty & Learning

- Most testers found Level 1 challenging but fair, especially once they adjusted to the movement
- The enemy count was considered appropriate for an introductory level
- A minority suggested adding a visual hint or prompt encouraging the use of the spear, to prevent players from attempting to avoid enemies instead of learning combat.

4. Key observed issues

<u>Issue observed</u>	<u>Impact</u>	<u>Suggested improvement</u>
Limited hit feedback	Reduces combat clarity	Add sound + hit flash
Attack animation feels slightly delayed	Confusion about damage timing	Re-time animation or delay damage
Difficulty understanding first fight	Slows onboarding	Add environmental cue or forced encounter

5. Post-testing changes implemented

<u>Change</u>	<u>Purpose</u>
Added stronger enemy hit reaction	Improve combat clarity
Adjusted spear attack timing	Make input feel more responsive
Added subtle tutorial cue through enemy placement	Encourage early combat learning
Decreased movement sensitivity	Improve feel of platforming control

6. Conclusion

The playtest confirmed that Level 1 provides an intuitive introduction to Misty Rainforest, with responsive physics and appropriate difficulty. However, the feedback emphasized the importance of stronger visual and auditory reinforcement during combat to help players better understand hit detection.

These changes directly improved game clarity and player satisfaction, shaping Level 1 into a more informative and polished opening experience.